


The medieval period saw the founding of many religious mutt or monasteries which also took up the cause of education. The Ahobila mutt in Srirangam was one among them where is Sri Ramanuja has made distinctive contribution to the cause of education. Besides mutts, Jain pallis and Buddhist vihars played a vital role in educating people where ever the existed. They had large libraries of books in all branches of learning.

## Modern System of Education

The beginning of the modern system of Indian education can be traced to the efforts of the Christian missionaries who arrived in India in the wake of European occupation. As a result of their efforts, many institutions were established across India. These institutions imparted Western as well as Indian education.

### Role of Christian Missionaries



**Francis Xavier**

Europeans came to India for trade and established trading companies. They acquired lands and constructed fortresses. Later they wanted to spread their culture and religion among Indians. The Europeans thought that they could make Indians understand the administration and religious theories better if they could impart education to the local population in their own method. So they started educational institutions. The Portuguese were the first Europeans who started modern system of education in India. Francis Xavier, a Jesuit, started a university at Cochin. They started many primary schools. The first college offering degrees on a completion of a course was started in Goa in 1575 where Christianity, logic, grammar and music were taught. John Kiernander was one of the most zealous pioneers and was perhaps the first missionary in India to introduce education for non-Christian children as an evangelistic agency. In 1812, Dr. C.S. John established 20 free reading schools in Tranquebar.



**Ziegenbalg**

Followed by the Portuguese, the French opened their institutions for all the Indians where education was imparted by Indian teachers through local languages. They started higher secondary schools where French language was taught. Two German Bishops, named Ziegenbalg and Plustscham, started schools and a training college for teachers in Travancore. After the arrival of English East India Company in 1600 AD(CE), institutions were established for imparting instruction in English. Gradually Sanskrit colleges were opened in Madras and Benaras. The first Bishop of Calcutta, the Revered Dr. Middleton, started a missionary college at Calcutta, which became famous as the Bishop's College. Mountstuart Elphinstone was actually a strong advocate of vernacular education, but on his retirement in 1827, his admirers collected funds and established a college offering English classes, named the Elphinstone College at Bombay. Missionaries made a good deal of attempt for the propagation of education in India. Due to their efforts many institutions were established.These institutions imparted Western education as well as Indian education.

### Education in the British Rule

History of education in British rule can be divided into four periods: (i) from the early days of the British rule up to 1813; (ii) period from 1813–1853; (iii) period from 1854–1920 and (iv) period from 1921–1947.



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